

Learning How to Learn: The Second Attempt

学会学习：第二次尝试

Theme: 学习方法与教育 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The second attempt began in **January** with a **slim brochure** and a **wide** table. **There** were **six** copies of the **manual**, a **dozen** notebooks, and a **mug** that said “read me twice”. “**So** this is the **semester** of **paper**,” Maya said. “**However**, a good **handbook** is not a **bestseller**.”

Both of them collected citations the way other people **collect** stamps, **rather** than the way examiners **collect** mistakes. A **quarterly commentary**, a **monthly dictionary** supplement, a **weekly song** sheet, and a **yearly** report were piled **above** the desk. “**Cite** the page,” Lin said. “**Quote** the line. Otherwise the reader cannot check us.” The **preface** of the **slim** volume was written last, and an **additional dozen** copies were ordered before anyone had read it.

He taught a short course on the **introduction** of numbers into prose. Experience, he said, is not information; a **battalion** of facts can hide a single mistake. A **coal** fire kept the **winter** evening warm, a **jacket** hung on the back of a chair, and a **bible** lay open at a genealogy: all made the same point — the staff usually remember what they can picture.

They sought a **dual** method: one page for the reader, one page for **oneself**. A **commentary** in the margin, a **datum** in the corner, and a second **commentary** on the **commentary** kept them honest. The art of it was restraint, and the education faculty noticed. A **monthly** review of their own pages, written in pencil, became the habit that held the whole project together.

Twelve thousand words later, the department could learn from the mistakes of the first edition. **Twenty** pages in, **nine** of them had to be rewritten; he did not **mention** it to the others. **Sometimes** they remembered the old wording; mostly they did not. “Seek the sort of sentence that can survive being read aloud,” she said, and **so** they did, in the school library, with the first snow of the year on the roof. **Above** the shelves a lamp burned all afternoon. The second attempt was not a correction of the first; it was a different book with the same subject, and both of them knew it.

中文翻译

第二次尝试在一月以一本薄薄的小册子和一张宽桌子开始。那里有六份手册、一打笔记本，还有一只写着“读我两遍”的杯子。“所以这就是纸的学期，”曼雅说，“不过，一本好手册不会是畅销书。”

他们两人像别人收集邮票那样收集引注，而不是像考官收集错误那样。一份季度评论、一份月度词典增补、一份每周歌单，以及一份年度报告，堆在桌子上方。“引用要给出页码，”林伟说，“引语要给出原句。否则读者无法核对。”这本薄书的前言是最后写的，而在任何人读过它之前，又加订了十二本。

他开了一门短课，讲数字如何被引入散文。他说，经验不是信息；一营的事实能掩盖一个错误。一个煤黑的冬夜、一件搭在椅背上的外套、一本翻在族谱处的圣经，都在说明同一点：职工通常只记得住自己能想象的东西。

他们寻求一种双重的方法：一页给读者，一页给自己。页边的评注、角落里的一个数据，以及关于评注的第二层评注，让他们保持诚实。它的艺术在于克制，而教育学院注意到了这一点。每月用铅笔写下一次对自己页面的复查，成了把整个项目维系在一起的习惯。

一万二千字之后，系里能够从第一版的错误中学习了。写到二十页时，其中九页必须重写；他没有向其他人提起这件事。有时他们记得旧的措辞，大多数时候不记得。“去寻找那种能被朗读出来的句子，”她说，于是他们就这样做了，在学校的图书馆里，屋顶上落着那年第一场雪。书架上方的灯整个下午都亮着。第二次尝试不是对第一次的修正；它是一本主题相同而内容不同的书，而他们两人都知道这一点。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
there ðeə POS: adv	adv. 在那里 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a location other than here; that place; r. in or at that place; r. in that matter; r. to or toward that place...
so seu POS: adv	adv. 如此, 如是, 如...那样; conj. 所以, 因此; pron. 这样 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. to a very great extent or degree; r. in a manner that facilitates; r. in such a condition or manner, especia...
however haʊ'eve POS: adv	adv. 然而, 无论如何, 究竟怎样; conj. 然而, 可是 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. despite anything to the contrary (usually following a concession); r. by contrast; on the other hand; the s...
six siks POS: num	num. 六, 六个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of five and one; s. denoting a quantity consisting of six items or units
paper 'peɪpə POS: n	n. 纸, 文件, 文章, 报纸, 证券, 证件; vt. 用纸糊, 贴壁纸于, 用纸包装; vi. 贴壁纸; a. 纸做的, 纸上的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a material made of cellulose pulp derived mainly from wood or rags or certain grasses; n. a medium for writ...
sometimes 'sʌmtaɪnz POS: adv	adv. 有时, 时常, 往往 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. on certain occasions or in certain cases but not always; at other times for six months"
rather 'ræðə POS: adv	adv. 宁可, 稍微, 相当 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. on the contrary; rather (or instead), he wrote her a letter"; r. to some (great or small) extent
wide waɪd POS: a	a. 宽的, 广阔的, 普遍的, 宽阔的, 广泛的, 一般的; adv. 广阔地, 遍及各处地, 广泛地; n. 大千世界 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having great (or a certain) extent from one side to the other; a. great in degree; s. having ample fabric; s. ...
twenty 'twenti POS: num	num. 二十, 二十个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of nineteen and one; s. denoting a quantity consisting of 20 items or u...
thousand 'θaʊznd POS: num	num. 千; a. 成千的, 许多的; n. 许许多多 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the product of 10 and 100; s. denoting a quantity consisting of 1,000 items or...
above ə'baʊ POS: prep	prep. 在上方, 超出; adv. 在上面; a. 上述的, 上面的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an earlier section of a written text; s. appearing earlier in the same text; r. at an earlier place; r. in or...
nine naɪn POS: num	num. 九, 九个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of eight and one; s. denoting a quantity consisting of one more than ei...
song sɒŋ POS: n	n. 歌, 曲, 鸣声, 歌唱, 歌曲, 诗歌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a short musical composition with words; n. a distinctive or characteristic sound; n. the act of singing; n. a...
mention 'menʃən POS: n	n. 提到, 言及, 陈述; vt. 提到, 提及 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a remark that calls attention to something or someone; n. an official recognition of merit; v. make referenc...
January 'dʒænjuəri POS: n	n. 一月 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the first month of the year; begins 10 days after the winter solstice
dozen 'dʌzn POS: n	n. 打, 十二个; a. 一打的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of eleven and one; s. denoting a quantity consisting of 12 items or units
collect kə'lekt POS: v	v. 收集, 聚集, 集中, 搜集; a. 由收到者付款的; adv. 由收到者付款地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a short prayer generally preceding the lesson in the Church of Rome or the Church of England; v. call for a...
winter 'wɪntə POS: n	n. 冬季, 萧条期, 衰退期; a. 冬天的; vt. 使度过冬天; vi. 过冬 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the coldest season of the year; in the northern hemisphere it extends from the winter solstice to the vern...
additional ə'dɪʃənəl POS: a	a. 附加的, 另外的, 额外的; [机] 加添的, 附加的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. further or added
introduction ,ɪntrə'dʌkʃən POS: n	n. 介绍, 传入, 采用, 初步 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of beginning something new; n. the first section of a communication; n. a basic or elementary instru...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
twelve twelv POS: num	num. 十二, 十二个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of eleven and one; s. denoting a quantity consisting of 12 items or uni...
coal kəul POS: n	n. 煤, 木炭; v. 加煤 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. fossil fuel consisting of carbonized vegetable matter deposited in the Carboniferous period; v. supply with...
cite sait POS: vt	vt. 引用, 引证, 表彰; [建] 引证, 指引 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a short note recognizing a source of information or of a quoted passage; v. make reference to; v. commend; v. ref...
quote kwəut POS: n	n. 引用; vt. 引述, 举证, 报(价); vi. 引用 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. repeat a passage from; v. name the price of; v. refer to for illustration or proof; v. put quote marks around
jacket 'dʒækɪt POS: n	n. 夹克, 外套, 护套; vt. 给...穿夹克, 给...装护套 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a short coat; n. an outer wrapping or casing; n. the outer skin of a potato; n. the tough metal shell casing...
bible 'baɪbl POS: n	n. 圣经 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the sacred writings of the Christian religions; n. a book regarded as authoritative in its field
weekly 'wi:kli POS: n	n. 周刊, 周报; a. 每周的, 一周一次的, 周刊的; adv. 每周, 一周一次 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a periodical that is published every week (or 52 issues per year); s. of or occurring every seven days
dictionary 'dɪkʃənəri POS: n	n. 字典, 词典; [计] 词典 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a reference book containing an alphabetical list of words with information about them
monthly 'mʌnθli POS: n	n. 月刊; a. 每月的, 每月一次的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a periodical that is published every month (or 12 issues per year); s. of or occurring or payable every mon...
manual 'mænjuəl POS: n	n. 手册, 指南; a. 手的, 手动的, 手工的, 体力的; [计] 人工的, 手动的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small handbook; a. of or relating to the hands; a. requiring human effort; s. doing or requiring physical w...
notebook 'nəʊtbuk POS: n	n. 笔记本, 手册, 期票簿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a book with blank pages for recording notes or memoranda; n. a small compact portable computer
slim slɪm POS: a	a. 瘦的, 苗条的, 微小的, 稀少的, 微薄的; vi. 变苗条; vt. 使苗条 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. take off weight; s. being of delicate or slender build; s. small in quantity
brochure 'brɒʃʊə POS: n	n. 小册子, 小册 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small book usually having a paper cover
dual 'dju:əl POS: a	a. 双重的, 双的; n. 双数 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. a grammatical number category referring to two items or units as opposed to one item (singular) or more th...
commentary 'kɒmentəri POS: n	n. 注释, 评论, 说明; [法] 注释, 评注, 评论 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a written explanation or criticism or illustration that is added to a book or other textual material
semester si'mestə POS: n	n. 学期 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one of two divisions of an academic year; n. half a year; a period of 6 months
mug mʌg POS: n	n. 有柄大杯, 脸, 苦读者; vt. 给...拍照, 攻击, 苦读; vi. 拼命用功 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quantity that can be held in a mug; n. with handle and usually cylindrical; v. rob at gunpoint or with t...
oneself wʌn'self POS: pron	pron. 自己, 亲自 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. A reflexive form of the indefinite pronoun one.; Commonly written as two words, one's self.
battalion bə'tæljən POS: n	n. 营, 军队, 集团 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an army unit usually consisting of a headquarters and three or more companies; n. a large indefinite number
handbook 'hænd,buk POS: n	n. 手册; [计] 手册 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a concise reference book providing specific information about a subject or location
yearly 'jiəli POS: a	a. 每年的, 一年一度的; adv. 一年一次, 每年 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a reference book that is published regularly once every year; s. occurring or payable every year; r. without mi...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
preface 'prefɪs POS: n	n. 序, 绪言, 前言; vi. 作序, 写前言; vt. 给...作序, 以...开始 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a short introductory essay preceding the text of a book; v furnish with a preface or introduction
quarterly 'kwɔ:təli POS: a	a. 季度的, 按季度的, 每季的; adv. 按季, 每三个月, 每季一次; n. 季刊 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a periodical that is published every quarter (or four issues per year); a. of or relating to or consisting...
bestseller phonetic unavailable POS: n	n. 畅销书 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a book that has had a large and rapid sale
datum 'deɪtəm POS: n	n. 论据, 材料, 资料, 已知数; [医] 材料, 资料, 论据 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an item of factual information derived from measurement or research